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Web Cadou Jr.

Sports Editor

TALK 'EM

IT'S THE GAME where — world's champions get knocked off by the club which tied for last place, the pitcher tabbed as the best right-hander in the league gets blasted out of the box in early innings, clubs battle tooth-and-nail into extra innings in the season opener just like it were the last game of the year.

That's what makes baseball the great game it is — the uncertainty. Or, if you prefer, the very certainty of the unexpected happening.

In no other game on the American sports scene is the caliber of the players so uniformly good. In no other game is the outcome of any given contest so unpredictable.

The difference between the great and the mediocre is so minute that it is not easily discernible in a single game or a single series.

But, it shows up over the long, hard pull of a 154-game season in the cold, hard light of statistics, those unglamorous but vital figures which separate the wheat from the chaff over the space of a season.

Opening day in the majors (save for a traditional presidential lifter in Washington) was typical of the kind of happening which makes baseball forever young and fresh.

Pittsburgh's Pirates, totally unawed by their glittering adversaries, the champion Braves, battle 14 innings to an upset victory. San Francisco's Giants, making their debut on the West Coast, shied Don Drysdale from the box and clobber the favored Los Angeles Dodgers.

No one, of course, is going to rush right out and — on the strength of yesterday's opening performances — bet the family bankroll on the Pirates or the Giants.

But, the point is there. On a given day, in a given ball game, you can never tell who is going to win, who is going to be the goat or the hero.

So, now we're off for another big year on the diamond. For five and a half months, the baseball fan will be in his glory. Every day will hold new surprises.

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MAYBE THE performance of the American Association baseball writers in picking our Indianapolis Indians to finish seventh in the league is a blessing.

The AA scribes often have been wrong in the past. We recall that Indianapolis was relegated to a second division finish in all the preseason dopes in both 1954 and 1956. Both times, the Tribesmen won the pennant. In 1956, they also captured the Junior World Series.

This year, not a single one

Scoreboard

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION

W	L	Pct.	GB	
INDIANAPOLIS	1	0	1,000	—
Minneapolis	0	1	.000	—
Omaha	1	0	1,000	—
St. Paul	0	1	.000	—
Charleston	1	0	1,000	—
Denver	0	1	.000	—
Louisville	0	1	.000	—
Wichita	0	1	.000	—

AMERICAN LEAGUE

W	L	Pct.	GB	
New York	1	0	1,000	—
Detroit	1	0	1,000	—
Baltimore	1	0	1,000	—
Kansas City	1	0	1,000	—
Washington	1	0	1,000	—
Chicago	0	1	.000	—
Cleveland	0	1	.000	—
Boston	0	1	.000	—

NATIONAL LEAGUE

W	L	Pct.	GB	
Chicago	1	0	1,000	—
Philadelphia	1	0	1,000	—
Pittsburgh	1	0	1,000	—
San Francisco	1	0	1,000	—
Cincinnati	0	1	.000	—
Los Angeles	0	1	.000	—
Milwaukee	0	1	.000	—
St. Louis	0	1	.000	—

Yesterday's Results

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION

INDIANAPOLIS 3, Detroit 0
St. Paul 6, Charleston 4 (11 innngs)
Minneapolis 3, Louisville 1
Omaha 2, Wichita 1 (12 innngs)

AMERICAN LEAGUE

Kansas City 5, Cleveland 0
Detroit 4, Chicago 3
Baltimore 6, Washington 1
New York 3, Boston 0

NATIONAL LEAGUE

San Francisco 8, Los Angeles 0
Pittsburgh 6, Cincinnati 4
Philadelphia 3, Milwaukee 3 (14 innngs)
Chicago 4, St. Louis 0

Today's Schedule

AMERICAN ASSOCIATION

Detroit at INDIANAPOLIS (7:45 p.m.)
St. Paul at Charleston (10:00)

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